آغا خان یونیورسٹی ایگزامینیشن بورڈ
AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

Notes from E-Marking Centre on HSSC-I Principles of Commerce Annual Examinations 2024

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC) Part I Principles of Commerce. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2024 HSSC-I Examination indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on candidates' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of candidates' responses that support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that requires candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during the course of study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfill the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used.

General Observations

Most candidates demonstrated a solid understanding of core concepts in the syllabus. Particularly, there was notable success in utilising the concepts different types of businesses and differentiating between various types of business organisations and modules of business. Many candidates excelled in demonstrating real life examples of different businesses and analysing the reasons for the growth of Multi-National Companies (MNCs). However, it is crucial for educators to focus on the following areas to enhance students' performance and ensure a thorough grasp of the subject matter:

- Ensure a clear distinction between different ways/ reasons when answering different aspects of case studies and extended response questions. This will help in providing more organised and comprehensive answers.
- Recognise and explain basics of business and commerce, such as formation business and its procedure, business and its role and impact on economy.
- Focus on practical application and case study analysis to improve strategic thinking. In order to do this, ensure critical reading of the question and proper content coverage.

Note: Candidates' responses shown in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format, or information.

DETAILED COMMENTS

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Question No. 1</th></tr>
<tr><td>Question Text</td><td>Identify the module of e-commerce from the given commercial transactions.

(Note: The first one has been done for your assistance)

<table>
<tr><th>S. No.</th><th>Scenario</th><th>Module of e-Commerce</th></tr>
<tr><td>1</td><td>General Motors has launched a web-based app through which different distributors can book their purchase orders online. The app will help them track the order status and expected delivery date.</td><td>Business-To-Business (B2B)</td></tr>
<tr><td>2</td><td>The government has announced an online tracking system for visa processing information to promote tourism. The application will update all visit visa applications.</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>3</td><td>Study Solutions is an online academy that provides personalised learning support materials and teacher training sessions to schools, colleges, and academic institutions.</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>4</td><td>Al-Hikma is a web-based drugstore that delivers herbal and traditional Eastern medicines to consumers across the globe.</td><td></td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>SLO No.</td><td>1.4.2</td></tr>
<tr><td>SLO Text</td><td>Explain forms (module) of e-commerce:
a. business-to-business (B2B)
b. business-to-consumer (B2C)
c. consumer-to-consumer (C2C)
d. consumer-to-business (C2B)
e. government (administration)-to-business (G2B)
f. business-to-government (administration) (B2G)
g. government (administration)-to-citizen (G2C);</td></tr>
<tr><td>Max Marks</td><td>3</td></tr>
<tr><td>Cognitive Level</td><td>*U</td></tr>
<tr><td>Checking Hints</td><td>Give ONE mark for each correct identification.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Overall Performance</td><td>The question was generally well-attempted by the candidates. A significant number of candidates showed proficiency in identifying the correct e-commerce modules. Few candidates were unable to perform well either because of lack of critical reading of the question or a weak understanding of different modules of e-commerce.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Description of Better Responses</td><td>Better responses highlighted the correct identification of each e-commerce module based on the scenarios provided. For example, they correctly matched the government’s online visa tracking system with the ‘government to consumer’ module, Study Solutions with ‘business to business’ and Al-Hikma with ‘business to consumers’.</td></tr>
</table>

Image of Better Response

S. No.	Scenario	Module of E-Commerce
1	General Motors has launched a web-based app through which different distributors can book their purchase orders online. The app will help them track the order status and expected delivery date.	Business-to-Business (B2B)
2	The government has announced an online tracking system for visa processing information to promote tourism. The application will update all visit visa applications.	Government to Citizen (G2C)
3	Study Solutions is an online academy that provides personalised learning support materials and conducted teacher training sessions to schools, colleges and academic institutions.	Business to Business (B2B)
4	Al-Hikma is a web-based drugstore that delivers herbal and traditional Eastern medicines to consumers across the globe.	Business to Consumers (B2C)

Description of Weaker Responses

In *weaker responses*, it was observed that candidates struggled with the concept of e-commerce modules or applied incorrect labels to the scenarios. For instance, some made errors in categorising 'Government to consumer' as 'Business to consumers' or 'Business to business' as 'Business to consumers'. In few cases, candidates partially answered the question and left some parts blank.

Image of Weaker Response

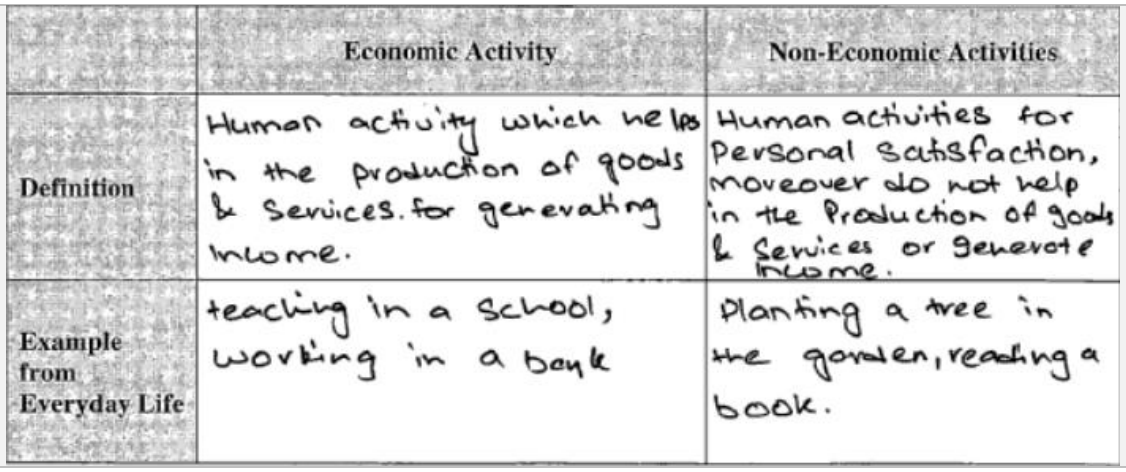
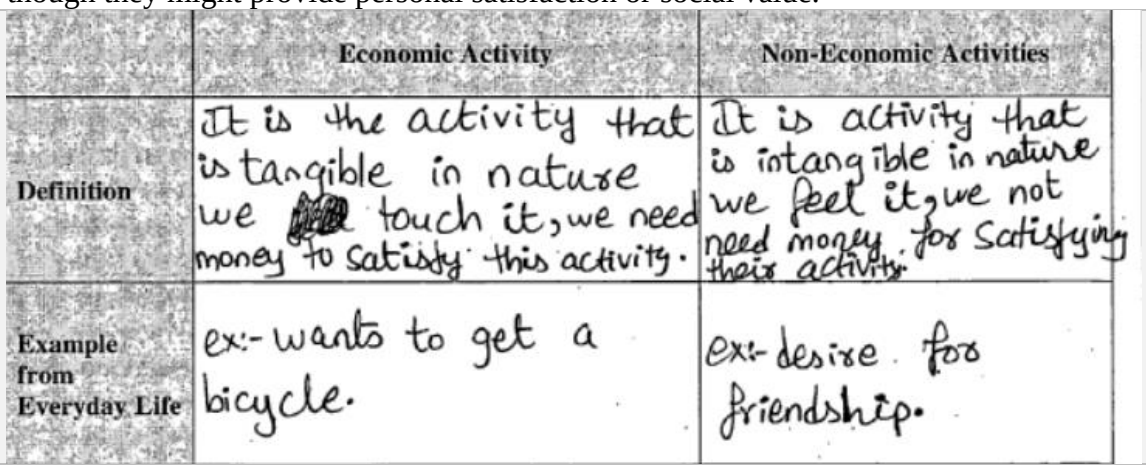
S. No.	Scenario	Module of E-Commerce
1	General Motors has launched a web-based app through which different distributors can book their purchase orders online. The app will help them track the order status and expected delivery date.	Business-to-Business (B2B)
2	The government has announced an online tracking system for visa processing information to promote tourism. The application will update all visit visa applications.	Goverment to Consumer (G2C)
3	Study Solutions is an online academy that provides personalised learning support materials and conducted teacher training sessions to schools, colleges and academic institutions.	Consumer to Consumer (C2C)
4	Al-Hikma is a web-based drugstore that delivers herbal and traditional Eastern medicines to consumers across the globe.	Consumer to Consumer (C2C)

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy** Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration ** For description of each Pedagogy, refer to Annexure A	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: Proper understanding of the specific characteristics of each module can help in accurately identifying them in various scenarios. Candidates should do a detailed study of different e-commerce modules and their applications. Teachers should ensure that more practice with a range of e-commerce scenarios could be done to improve candidates' ability to apply their knowledge effectively.		

*K = Knowledge U = Understanding A = Application and other higher-order cognitive skills

Question No. 2	
Question Text	Compare and contrast economic and non-economic activities with examples from everyday life.
SLO No.	1.1.2
SLO Text	Differentiate between economic and non-economic activity;
Max Marks	2
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for defining the term Give ONE mark for the example of the activity
Overall Performance	The performance on this question showed a good understanding of the comparison between economic and non-economic activities. Most candidates performed well on this question indicating a solid grasp of the topic. However, there were few candidates who either gave general explanations or irrelevant examples.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* provided clear definitions of both economic and non-economic activities. They also included appropriate examples from everyday life to illustrate each type of activity. For example, they correctly identified economic activities as those involving financial transactions, such as earning a salary or running a business, and non-economic activities as those not involving financial gain, such as volunteering or doing household chores.

Images of Better Responses	
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* made errors in their definitions and explanations. For instance, some described non-economic activities as simply 'intangible' or a 'waste of time'. These responses were considered insufficient because they did not accurately reflect the concept of non-economic activities, which are characterised by the absence of monetary benefits rather than their intangibility or perceived worth. A more accurate definition should include the idea that non-economic activities do not generate monetary benefits or profits, even though they might provide personal satisfaction or social value.
Images of Weaker Responses	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion:		

Question No. 3	
Question Text	Exemplify any THREE sole owner businesses that require licence for their operations in Pakistan.
SLO No.	2.2.3
SLO Text	Discuss the merits and demerits of sole-proprietorship;
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each example (THREE required). All other relevant examples are acceptable, provided they are sole owners.
Overall Performance	A significant number of candidates demonstrated a strong grasp of the topic, providing accurate examples of such businesses. However, there was also a considerable portion who struggled to identify the businesses correctly or did not provide sufficient details. Some candidates were unable to address the question effectively, resulting in varied levels of success in their responses.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses*, candidates provided correct examples of sole owner business. Examples such as medical stores, restaurants, alcohol stores, hospitals, etc were mentioned. M ostly candidates gave examples of entrepreneur businesses.
Image of Better Response	1. Arms and Ammunition-Businesses 2. Pharmaceutical Business 3. Alcohol/Wine Shop
Description of Weaker Responses	In *weaker responses*, candidates discussed businesses typically incorporated under the Companies Act or those requiring large-scale management and capital. Some mentioned vague business entities or referred to businesses needing registration documents like a memorandum and articles of association, while others used broad terms such as manufacturing and trading businesses instead of identifying specific trading businesses that require licensing.
Image of Weaker Response	1. Trading busniess with other contries 2. Manafacturing for certain good's 3. Food busniess (from small restrunt to large)

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion: To improve, teachers are encouraged to assist candidates in familiarising themselves with specific examples of licensed businesses and their operational requirements especially in Pakistan. Additionally, practicing how to clearly and accurately list and describe these businesses would help in providing more comprehensive answers. Ensuring they are well-informed about the licensing process and its significance for different types of sole owner businesses will enhance their responses in similar future questions.

Question No. 4

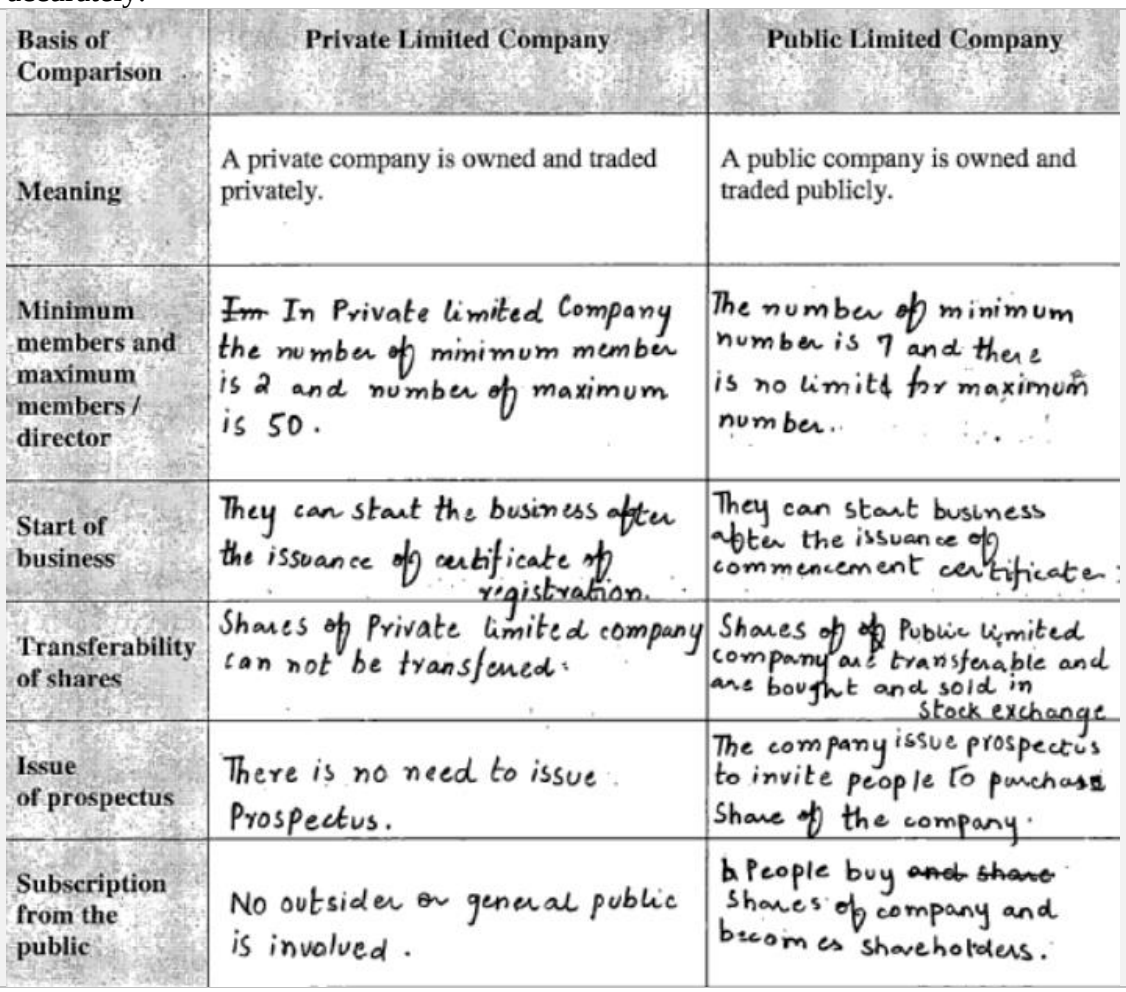
Question Text

Compare private limited and public limited companies on the given basis.

[Note: Attempt any THREE. The first one has been done for your assistance.]

Basis of comparison	Private Limited Company	Public Limited Company
Meaning	A private company is owned and traded privately.	A public company is owned and traded publicly.
Minimum members and maximum members		
Start of business		
Transferability of shares		
Issue of prospectus		
Subscription from the public		

SLO No.	2.8.3
SLO Text	Differentiate between public limited Co. and private limited Co;
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each comparison (THREE required)
Overall Performance	The question was generally well-attempted. The responses effectively discussed aspects such as ownership, share transferability, and regulatory requirements. However, there were also some candidates who had difficulty providing a clear and accurate comparison. This variation indicated that while a significant number of candidates performed well, there was a range of comprehension levels regarding the distinctions between private and public limited companies.

Description of Better Responses	Most candidates successfully identified and wrote three correct points, clearly differentiating between private and public limited companies based on the parameters. They mentioned the minimum and maximum membership number ranges (i.e. 2 and 7 directors respectively and 200, except in the case of a person company and unlimited members respectively), the criteria for starting the business that includes attending a certificate of incorporation, and the differences in ownership transferability related to shares and investments. Although fewer candidates addressed the distinction regarding the issuance of prospectuses and public subscriptions, those who did were able to articulate their answers accurately.
Image of Better Response	

Basis of Comparison	Private Limited Company	Public Limited Company
Meaning	A private company is owned and traded privately.	A public company is owned and traded publicly.
Minimum members and maximum members / director	~~Im~~ In Private limited Company the number of minimum member is 2 and number of maximum is 50.	The number of minimum number is 7 and there is no limit for maximum number.
Start of business	They can start the business after the issuance of certificate of registration.	They can start business after the issuance of commencement certificate.
Transferability of shares	Shares of Private limited company can not be transfered.	Shares of of Public limited company are transferable and are bought and sold in stock exchange
Issue of prospectus	There is no need to issue Prospectus.	The company issue prospectus to invite people to purchase Share of the company.
Subscription from the public	No outsider or general public is involved.	People buy ~~and share~~ Shares of company and becomes shareholders.

Description of Weaker Responses	In *weaker responses*, some candidates provided incorrect information about the number of members and directors. Others mistakenly claimed that starting a private company is easier than starting a public company. In fact, candidates should have pointed out that a private company requires only a certificate of incorporation or registration, while a public company needs both a certificate of incorporation and a certificate of commencement to begin operations. Additionally, some candidates incorrectly stated that shares in a private company are non-transferable. While shares in a private company can be transferred, there are certain restrictions on their transferability.

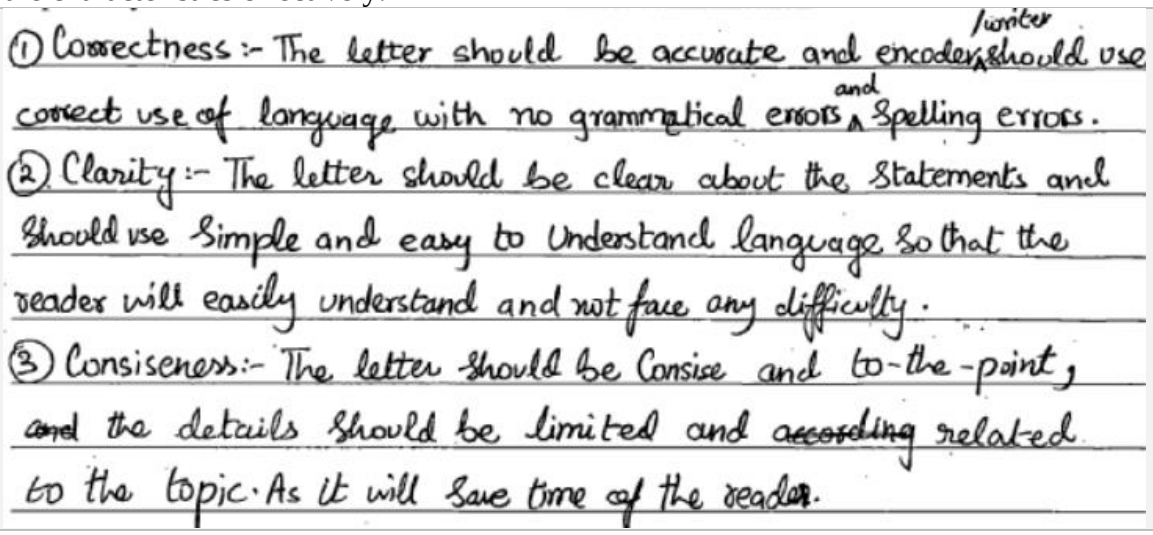
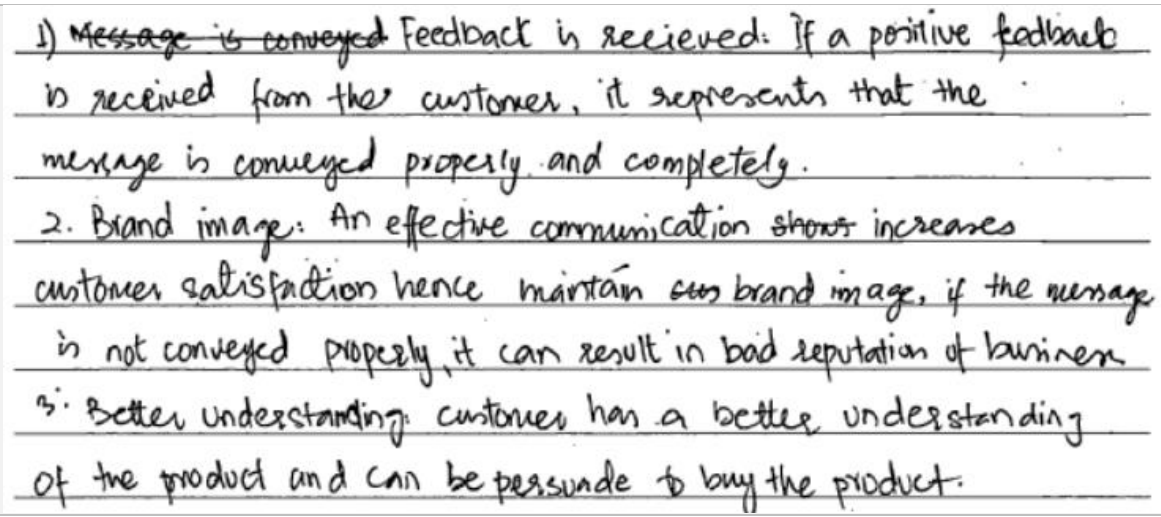
Image of Weaker Response

Basis of Comparison	Private Limited Company	Public Limited Company
Meaning	A private company is owned and traded privately.	A public company is owned and traded publicly.
Minimum members and maximum members / director	Minimum ~~meberss~~ members are 2 and maximum are 50	Minimum members are 7 and maximum are unlimited
Start of business		
Transferability of shares	shares cannot ~~get be~~ transfered to general public	shares can be transfered to general public.
Issue of prospectus	It requires the issuance of Prospectus	It requires the issuance of memorandum of association, Article of association
Subscription from the public		

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Pedagogy Used for that SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion: To improve their responses to this question, candidates should focus on gaining a clearer understanding of the differences between private limited and public limited companies. They should ensure they can accurately describe key aspects such as ownership structure, share trading, and regulatory requirements. Enhancing their ability to make detailed comparisons and organise their thoughts coherently will also help in presenting more effective answers. Practice with example comparisons and a thorough review of the characteristics of each type of company will contribute to better performance in future questions on this topic.

Question No. 5	
Question Text	Explain any THREE characteristics of effective business communication.
SLO No.	7.2.1
SLO Text	Describe the characteristics of an effective business communication (Oral/ Written);
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Award ONE mark for every correct explanation. (THREE required)
Overall Performance	It was observed that the performance on this question varied widely. Many candidates were able to describe at least one characteristic effectively, but a large number of candidates struggled to provide clear and accurate explanations.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses*, candidates effectively explained the characteristics demonstrated a firm understanding of the concept, accurately addressing traits like clarity, correctness, conciseness, completeness, consideration, concreteness, and courtesy. They also provided relevant, well-connected examples to illustrate these points. In some responses, candidates did not use the specific vocabulary of the 7Cs but were still able to articulate and explain the characteristics effectively.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	In *weaker responses* candidates state vague or incomplete statements describing the essentials of effective communication. some candidates wrote about the benefits that a business gains from effective communication. Others described the process for achieving effective communication or discussed the impact of effective communication on employees. All these responses were considered incorrect because the question specifically asked for the characteristics known as the 7 Cs.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: To improve their responses, candidates should focus on understanding and clearly articulating key characteristics of effective business communication. They should aim to provide detailed explanations of each characteristic and ensure their answers are well-organised. Reviewing core principles of effective communication and practicing how to explain them in their own words will help candidates perform better in similar questions in the future.		

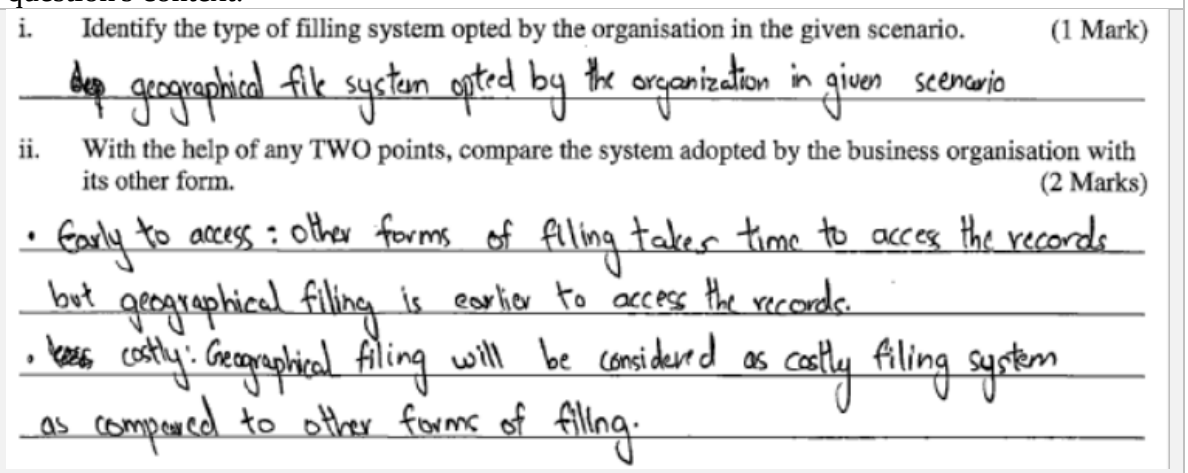
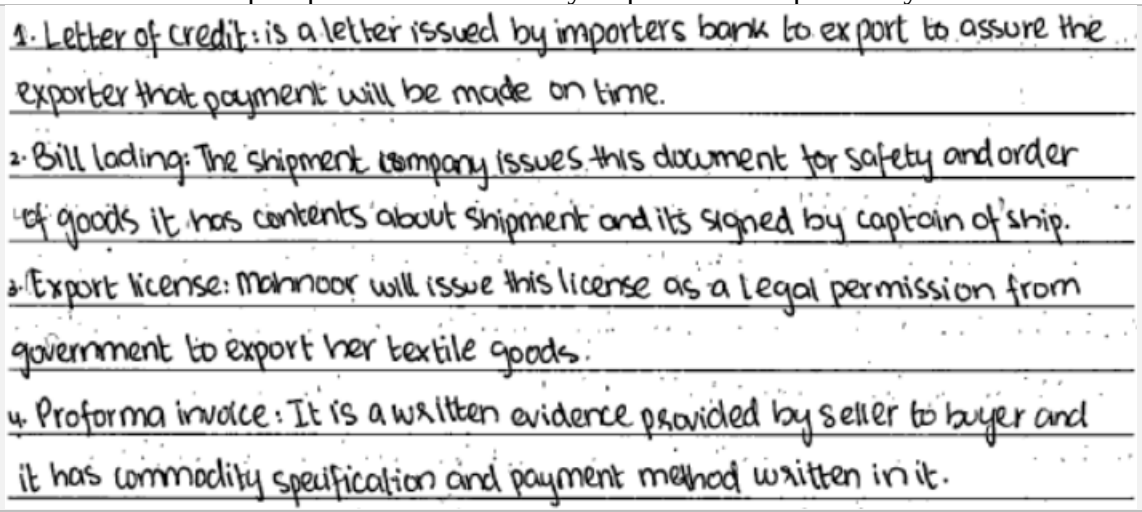
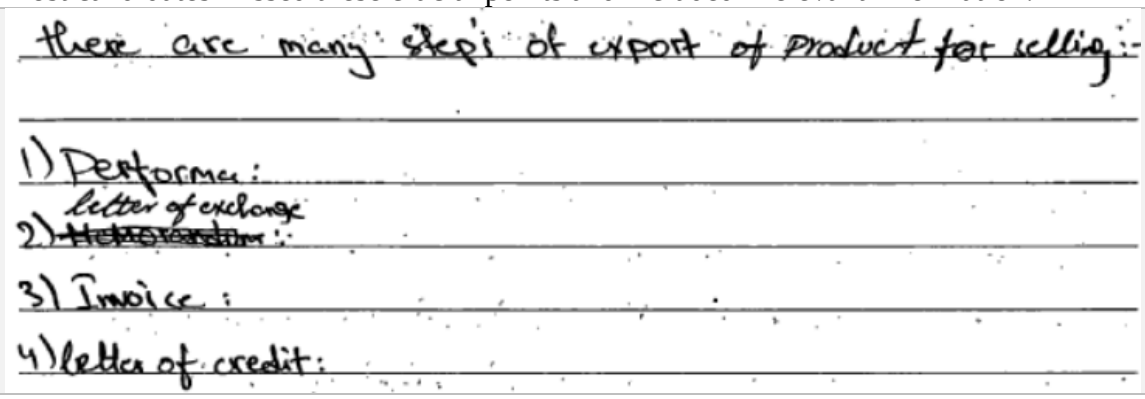
Question No. 6	
Question Text	Al-Rehmat & Co., a Multi-National Companies (MNCs), is undergoing a departmental restructuring with a focus on filing system. To facilitate this, country managers have been appointed for each department, empowering them with decision-making authority. These country managers are tasked with independently overseeing and managing their respective departments with reference to its geographical location. i. Identify the type of filling system opted by the organisation in the given scenario. ii. With the help of any TWO points, compare the system adopted by the business organisation with its other form.
SLO No.	3.2.4
SLO Text	Differentiate between the followings with reference to its merit and demerits: a. horizontal and vertical filing system b. centralised and decentralised filing system;
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for identification. Give ONE mark for each comparison (TWO required).
Overall Performance	The overall performance showed that a good number of candidates understood the concept and were able to identify the filing system and provide a comparison. However, a substantial number of candidates struggled with accurately identifying the system and making a meaningful comparison. This resulted in a mix of well-developed answers and those lacking in detail or clarity.
Description of Better Responses	In *Better responses*, most candidates correctly identified the type of filing system and accurately compared both systems. As a result, they performed well. Most candidates made comparisons based on the merits and demerits related to space, time, human resources, financial cost, flexibility, adaptability, and compatibility with the requirements mentioned in the scenario, effectively demonstrating a clear connection and coherence with the question's context.
Image of Better Response	 i. Identify the type of filling system opted by the organisation in the given scenario. (1 Mark) Geographical file system opted by the organization in given scenario ii. With the help of any TWO points, compare the system adopted by the business organisation with its other form. (2 Marks) • Early to access : other forms of filing takes time to access the records but geographical filing is earlier to access the records. • less costly: Geographical filing will be considered as costly filing system as compared to other forms of filing.
Description of Weaker Responses	In *Weaker responses* candidates identified the wrong filing method and failed to accurately compare the pros and cons of the filing methods. Additionally, some candidates discussed only the filing system they selected, without comparing it to the other system, which was a requirement of the question, resulting in a loss of marks.

Image of Weaker Response	i. Identify the type of filling system opted by the organisation in the given scenario. (1 Mark) De-centrilised filling system. ii. With the help of any TWO points, compare the system adopted by the business organisation with its other form. (2 Marks) Country managers have been appointed for each department which means they're following decentrilised filling system because it follows secondary employees managing the system.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion: To improve their performance, candidates should focus on thoroughly understanding different types of filing systems and their characteristics. They should practice identifying these systems in various scenarios and comparing them effectively. Clear explanations and comparisons, supported by relevant points, would help in providing more comprehensive answers. Reviewing case studies or examples of different filing systems can enhance their ability to tackle similar questions in the future.

Question No. 7	
Question Text	Mahnoor is a Pakistani textile designer. She wishes to access the foreign market but is unaware of the procedures required for foreign trade. With reference to the given situation, describe the FOUR major steps or trade documents required for export.
SLO No.	4.5.3
SLO Text	Illustrate the purpose of various trade documents required for international trade;
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for describing each correct step. (FOUR Required) Note: The description and arrangement of steps may vary candidate-wise, but the procedure will remain the same.
Overall Performance	The question was about purpose of trade documents. Overall, this question was challenging for the candidates as many candidates struggled providing a complete and accurate description of the steps or documents, resulting in a wide range of responses. While some demonstrated a strong understanding and detailed their knowledge effectively, a large portion of candidates had difficulty addressing the question comprehensively.
Description of Better Responses	Responses that included all four documents with clear and effective descriptions were highly regarded. The documents mentioned were the letter of credit (L/C), bill of lading (B/L), export license, proforma invoice, and consular invoice. Likewise, responses that summarized the export procedure in four key steps were also positively noted.
Image of Better Response	 1. Letter of credit: is a letter issued by importers bank to export to assure the exporter that payment will be made on time. 2. Bill lading: The shipment company issues this document for safety and order of goods it has contents about shipment and its signed by captain of ship. 3. Export license: Mahnoor will issue this license as a legal permission from government to export her textile goods. 4. Proforma invoice: It is a written evidence provided by seller to buyer and it has commodity specification and payment method written in it.
Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* simply listed the bill of lading, bill of exchange, letter of credit, consular invoice, and pro forma invoice without providing descriptions. Additionally, candidates who described the export procedure did not summarise the entire procedure in four major steps. They were expected to cover obtaining an order or indent, preparing a letter of credit, procuring goods and shipment, and finally, packaging and dispatching goods. However, most candidates missed these crucial points and included irrelevant information.
Image of Weaker Response	 there are many steps of export of product for selling:- 1) Performa: 2) letter of exchange 3) Invoice: 4) letter of credit:

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: To improve their performance, candidates should focus on thoroughly understanding the procedure of trade and how different trade documents are involved at different stages of foreign trade. This can be achieved by assigning students to draw the plan to export as an imaginary product following all the necessary documents and steps.		

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Question No. 8</th></tr>
<tr><td>Question Text</td><td>With reference to the product life cycle (with reference to present times), complete the given table any TWO of the given products.
<table>
<tr><th>Product</th><th>Stage of Product Life Cycle</th><th>Feature of the Stage</th></tr>
<tr><td>Typewriter
  </td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Electric Car
  </td><td></td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Smart Phone
  </td><td></td><td></td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>SLO No.</td><td>5.3.7</td></tr>
<tr><td>SLO Text</td><td>Draw a product life cycle diagram (taking into account an imaginary product);</td></tr>
<tr><td>Max Marks</td><td>3</td></tr>
<tr><td>Cognitive Level</td><td>U</td></tr>
<tr><td>Checking Hints</td><td>Give ONE mark for describing each phase of product life cycle i.e. introduction, growth, maturity and decline.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Overall Performance</td><td>The performance showed a high level of understanding of the concept by the cohort. Candidates correctly identified and described the stages of the product life cycle for their chosen products. However, there was also a few candidates who struggled with the task, resulting in a mix of responses that ranged from well-developed to incomplete or inaccurate.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Description of Better Responses</td><td>Most candidates were able to answer the question correctly, providing accurate stages of the product life cycle (i.e., introduction, growth, maturity, and decline) and effectively explaining their features with reference to given image.</td></tr>
</table>

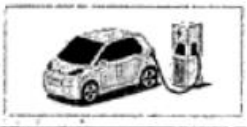
Image of Better Response

Product	Stage of Product Life Cycle	Feature of the Stage
Typewriter 	Decline stage	In this stage the sale of Product decreases with the time, The company face loss in this stage.
Electric Car 	Growth stage	In this stage with the Passage of Time the sales rises quickly and company makes Large Profit -
Smart Phone 	Maturity stage	In this stage the sales rate is constant. Does not increase or decrease. company Promotes its Product constanly but sales rate is constant.

Description of Weaker Responses

Weaker responses highlighted the candidate's struggle with classifying the stages. For example, candidates incorrectly classified the typewriter as being in the growth stage. Similarly, candidates identified the wrong stages for two other products.

Image of Weaker Response

Product	Stage of Product Life Cycle	Feature of the Stage
Typewriter 	~~Growth~~ Introduction	It shows the starting of the product that is now old in present times.
Electric Car 		
Smart Phone 	maturity	This stage is now on its mature stage it does not need extension because its already matured by now.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

• Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion: To improve, candidates should focus on understanding the product life cycle stages and how they apply to different products. They should study how products like typewriters, electric cars, and smartphones evolve over time and the characteristics of each stage in their life cycle. Practicing with various examples and familiarising themselves with the current market trends for these products will help in providing more accurate and detailed answers. Additionally, reviewing how to effectively analyse and compare different products within their life cycles can enhance their performance in similar questions.

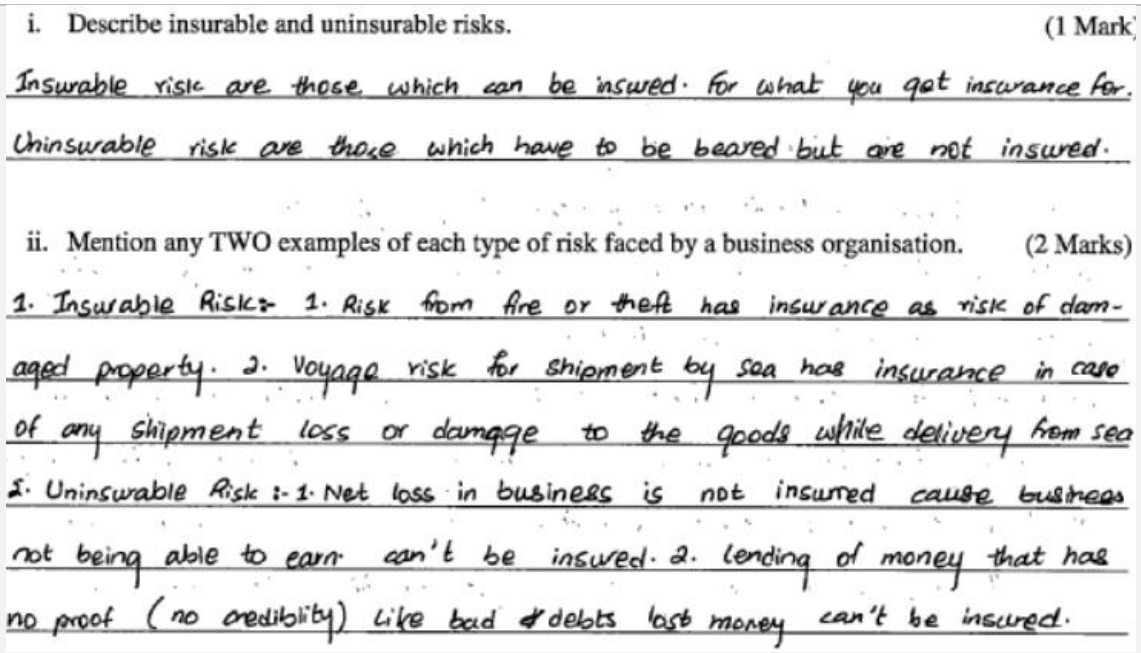
Question No. 9	
Question Text	Describe insurable and uninsurable risks. Mention any TWO examples of each type of risk faced by a business organisation.
SLO No.	6.2.3/ 6.2.6
SLO Text	Describe the different types of business risk, i.e.: * a. insurable and uninsurable b. internal and external c. controllable and uncontrollable/; explain the types of insurance, i.e.: * a. insurance for persons (personal and life) b. property insurance (fire, marine and miscellaneous) c. insurance of liability d. insurance of interest and rights (credit and fidelity)
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each description Give one mark for each example.
Overall Performance	Many candidates generally demonstrated a clear understanding of the concepts, providing detailed descriptions and relevant examples while effectively differentiating between insurable and uninsurable risks. However, some candidates struggled, offering incomplete descriptions or inadequate examples, leading to varied performance levels.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* provided accurate descriptions of insurable and uninsurable risks and correctly gave two examples of each type of risk faced by a business organisation, like fire damage, theft, accidents, product liability for insurable and market fluctuations, changes in government policy, competitive risk, reputation damage and technological obsolescence for uninsurable risk.
Image of Better Response	 i. Describe insurable and uninsurable risks. (1 Mark) Insurable risk are those which can be insured. for what you got insurance for. Uninsurable risk are those which have to be beared but are not insured. ii. Mention any TWO examples of each type of risk faced by a business organisation. (2 Marks) 1. Insurable Risk:- 1. Risk from fire or theft has insurance as risk of damaged property. 2. Voyage risk for shipment by sea has insurance in case of any shipment loss or damage to the goods while delivery from sea 2. Uninsurable Risk :- 1. Net loss in business is not insured cause business not being able to earn can't be insured. 2. Lending of money that has no proof (no credibility) like bad debts lost money can't be insured.
Description of Weaker Responses	Some candidates provided incorrect definitions of insurable and uninsurable risks, such as stating that insurable risks are predictable or controllable. Other candidates confused the concepts of insurable and uninsurable risks, describing them as risks related to items that were insurable but not insured by the owner, and thus the insurance company would not compensate for the losses.

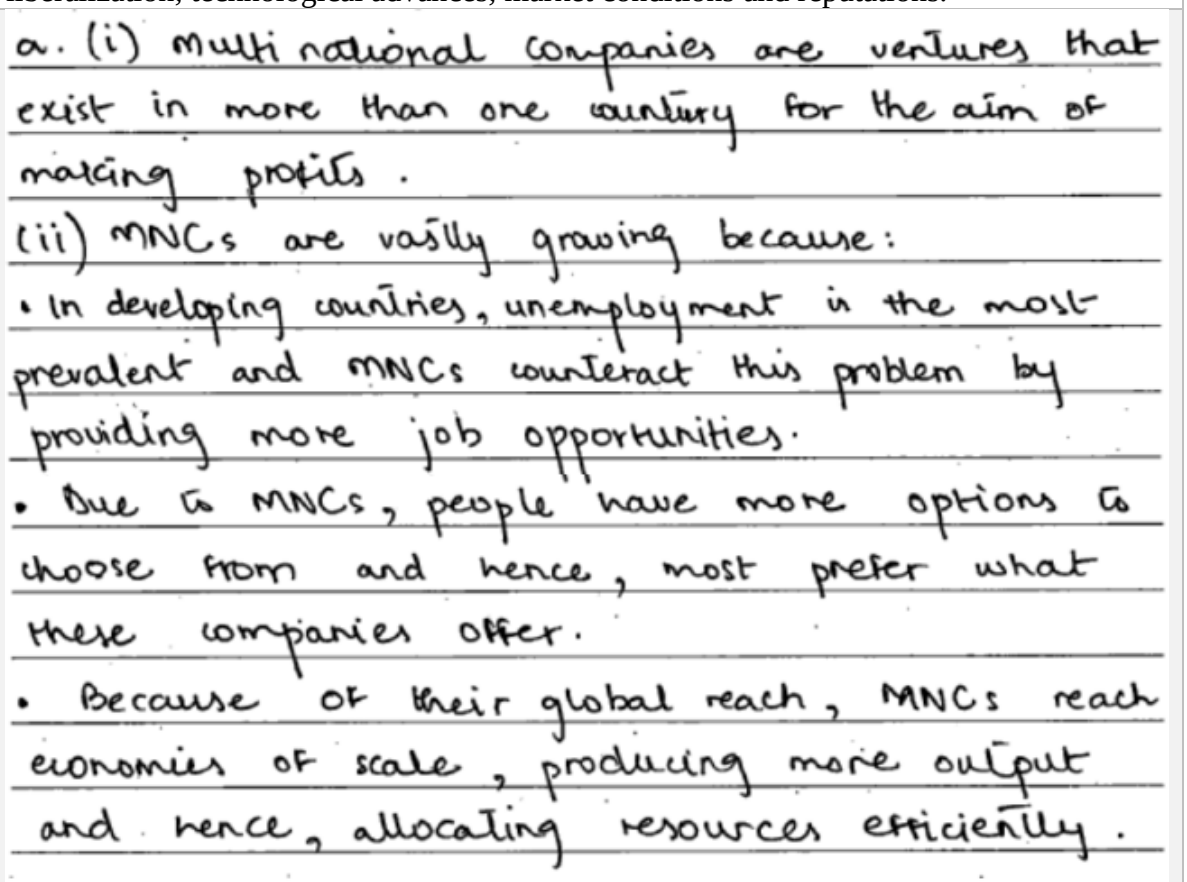
Image of Weaker Response	i. Describe insurable and uninsurable risks. (1 Mark) 1- insurable :- Insurable Risks means the person is sure about the risk took risk but arn't very sure 2. Uninsurable:- Uninsurable Risks means that they ~~did not took any risk~~. ii. Mention any TWO examples of each type of risk faced by a business organisation. (2 Marks) 1- They face the risk of the loss in business or any type of misunderstandings. Example: like not being able to pay loan. 2. They face the risk like having difficulties in their organisation. Example: Members leaving the Company because they are not very sure about what is gonna happen to this Company.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	**Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO**	**Assessment Strategies**
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: To improve, candidates should focus on clearly understanding the definitions and characteristics of insurable and uninsurable risks. They should practice identifying and describing these risks with relevant examples, ensuring they can distinguish between them accurately. Reviewing case studies or practical examples of risks faced by businesses can enhance their ability to provide more comprehensive answers. Additionally, better organisation of their responses and thorough explanations will help in addressing similar questions more effectively.		

Extended Response Questions (ERQs)

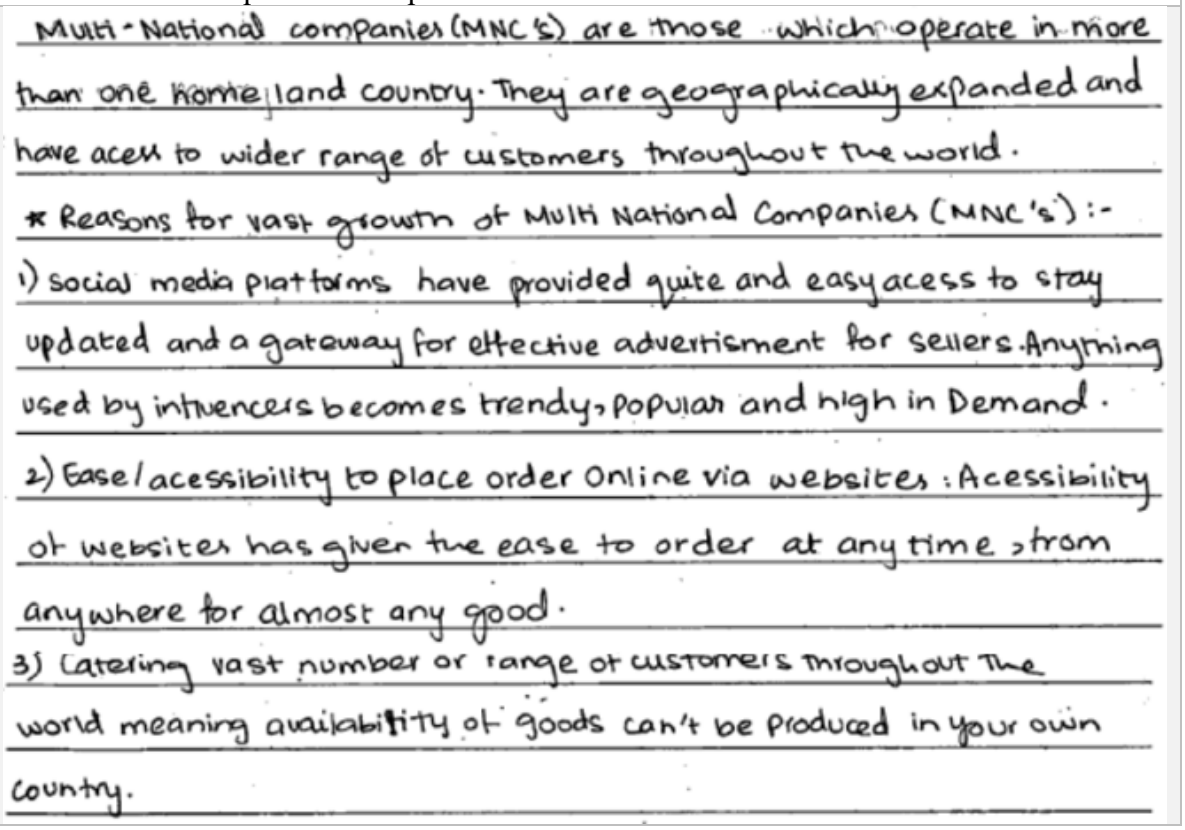
Extended response questions offered a choice between parts 'a' and 'b'

Question No. 10a	
Question Text	i. Define Multi-National Companies (MNCs). ii. Discuss any THREE reasons for the vast growth of Multi-National Companies (MNCs) in the global economy and specifically in developing countries.
SLO No.	2.14.1
SLO Text	Discuss the reasons for vast growth of multi-national Companies (MNCs) in global economy
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for defining the MNC. Give ONE mark for describing the reason for the global growth of MNC an additional ONE mark for relating it to developing countries (THREE required).
Overall Performance	This is a choice-based question and mostly students opted the part a which are regarding the MNC. The overall performance showed that many candidates were able to clearly define MNCs and provide detailed reasons for their growth. A significant number of candidates presented well-structured and comprehensive answers. However, there were also candidates who struggled with either defining MNCs or explaining the reasons for their growth, resulting in a range of responses from well-developed to incomplete.
Description of Better Responses	Candidates accurately defined multinational corporations (MNCs) and discussed three specific reasons for their significant growth in developing countries. These candidates effectively addressed how MNCs expanded in developing regions, demonstrating a clear understanding of the factors contributing to this growth like access to new markets, cost advantages, favourable investment policies. Students mentioned factors like economic liberalization, technological advances, market conditions and reputations.
Image of Better Response	

a. (i) multi national companies are ventures that exist in more than one country for the aim of making profits.

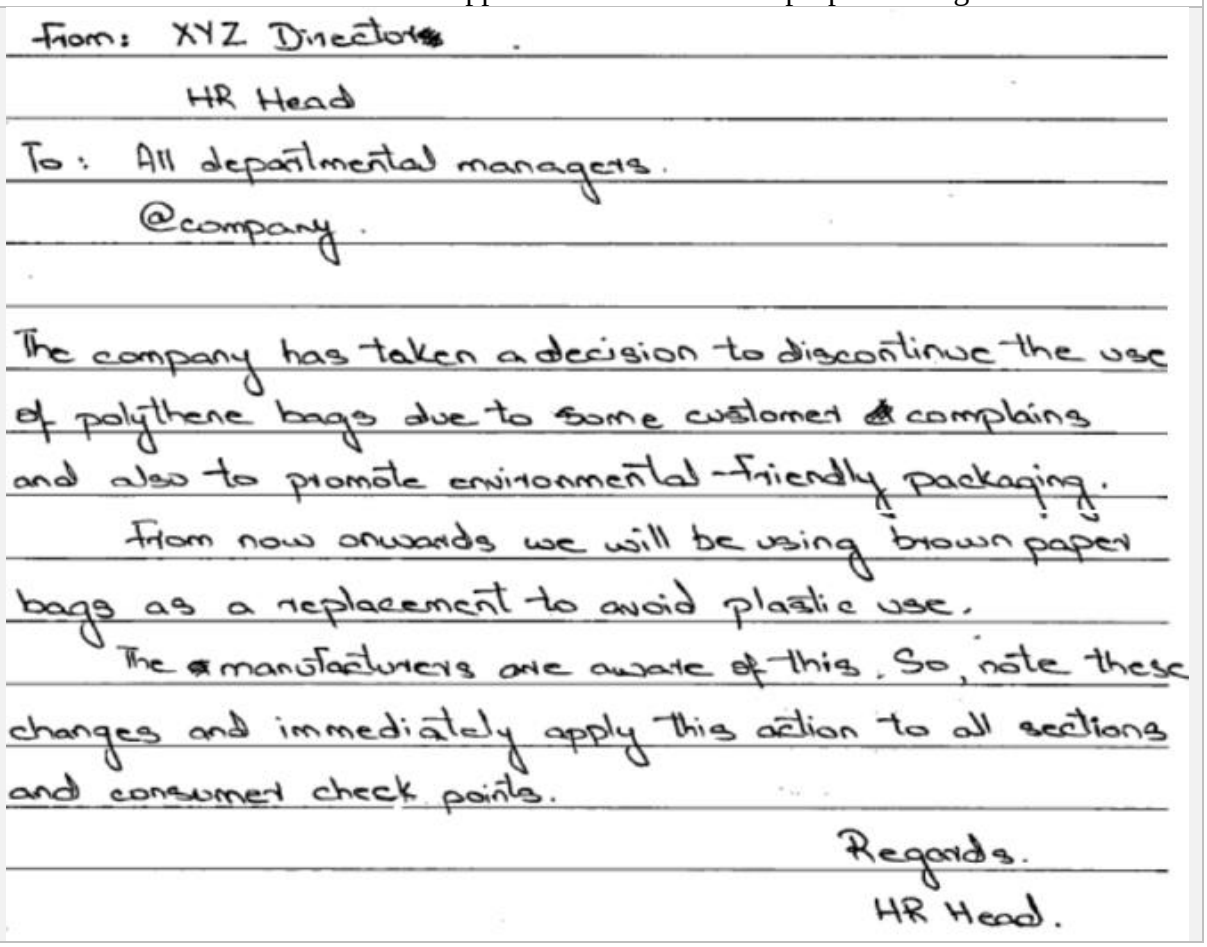
(ii) MNCs are vastly growing because:

- In developing countries, unemployment is the most prevalent and MNCs counteract this problem by providing more job opportunities.
- Due to MNCs, people have more options to choose from and hence, most prefer what these companies offer.
- Because of their global reach, MNCs reach economies of scale, producing more output and hence, allocating resources efficiently.

Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* focused on the potential benefits of MNCs, rather than addressing the specific reasons for their growth in developing countries. Additionally, they also provided general reasons without relating them to the context of developing countries. For instance, responses that discussed MNCs' benefits or growth factors in a broad or unrelated manner failed to meet the question's requirements.
Image of Weaker Response	 Multi-National companies (MNC's) are those which operate in more than one home land country. They are geographically expanded and have acess to wider range of customers throughout the world. * Reasons for vast growth of Multi National Companies (MNC's):- 1) social media platforms have provided quite and easy acess to stay updated and a gateway for effective advertisment for sellers. Anything used by influencers becomes trendy, popular and high in Demand. 2) Ease/acessibility to place order Online via websites: Acessibility of websites has given the ease to order at any time, from anywhere for almost any good. 3) Catering vast number or range of customers throughout The world meaning availability of goods can't be produced in your own country.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Pedagogy Used for that SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: To improve, candidates should focus on thoroughly understanding the concept of MNCs and the factors driving their growth. They should practice defining MNCs clearly and identifying key reasons for their expansion, especially in developing countries. Reviewing current examples and trends in global business can provide better insights into the growth of MNCs. Additionally, candidates should work on organising their answers more effectively and ensuring they cover all parts of the question in detail.		

Question No. 10b	
Question Text	To promote environmental packaging, the management of Diamond Departmental Stores decided that their stores will cut-off the use of polythene bags and use brown paper bags. This decision is applicable to all sections and consumer checkout points. Draft a memo for the given business decision for internal communication.
SLO No.	7.4.27
SLO Text	Draft 'business memorandum' with the necessary details;
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for the subject line. Give ONE mark for the introduction. Give ONE mark for correct use of tenses (at least 3 errors). Give ONE mark for correct use of spelling (at least 3 errors). Give ONE mark for correct use of subject-verb agreement (at least 3 errors). Give ONE mark for mentioning the packaging changes. Give ONE mark for concluding remarks.
Overall Performance	Generally, candidates who demonstrated a strong grasp of internal communication produced clear and appropriate memos, while others struggled with the format and content. The responses ranged from minimal effort to more detailed attempts, highlighting a contrast between well-executed memos and those that fell short of the required standards.
Description of Better Responses	Candidates adhered to the correct format for a business memo and included the subject line and date. They effectively described the body of the memo, which included an introduction to the topic, a discussion of the main subject, and a conclusion. They also specified the date from which the decision would be applicable and included a proper closing.
Images of Better Responses	

From: XYZ Director
HR Head

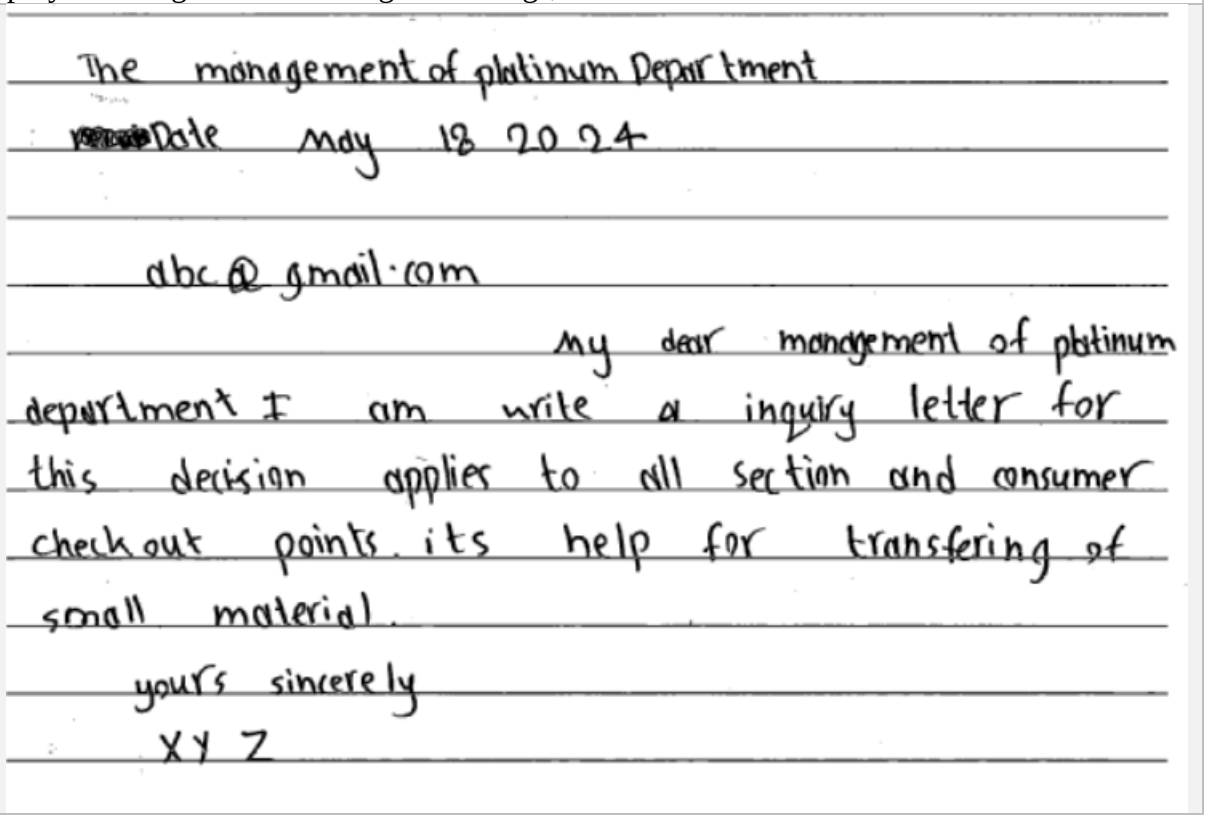
To: All departmental managers.
@company.

The company has taken a decision to discontinue the use of polythene bags due to some customer complains and also to promote environmental-friendly packaging.

From now onwards we will be using brown paper bags as a replacement to avoid plastic use.

The manufacturers are aware of this. So, note these changes and immediately apply this action to all sections and consumer check points.

Regards.
HR Head.

Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* provided only the body of the memo without adhering to the required format or including a subject line. Others misunderstood the criteria for writing a business memo and erroneously thanked the management for their decision to discontinue polythene bags. Some candidates suggested that the management should discontinue the use of polythene bags and start using brown bags, which was not the intended task.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: To improve, candidates should focus on understanding the key elements of a well-structured memo, including clear communication of the main points and appropriate tone for internal announcements. They should practice drafting memos with specific details, such as the reason for the change, its impact on operations, and any necessary instructions for staff. Reviewing sample memos and familiarising themselves with internal communication standards will help in crafting more effective and professional memos in the future.		

Annexure A: Pedagogies Used for Teaching the SLOs

Pedagogy: Storyboard
Description: A visual pedagogy that uses a series of illustrated panels to present a narrative, encouraging creativity and critical thinking. It helps learners organise ideas, sequence events, and comprehend complex concepts through storytelling.
Example: In a Literature class, students are tasked with creating storyboards to visually retell a novel. They draw key scenes, write captions, and present their stories to the class, enhancing their reading comprehension and fostering their imagination.

Pedagogy: Cause and Effect
Description: This pedagogy explores the relationships between actions and consequences. By analysing cause-and-effect relationships, learners develop a deeper understanding of how events are interconnected and how one action can lead to various outcomes.
Example: In a History class, students study the causes and effects of the Industrial Revolution. They research and discuss how technological advancements in manufacturing led to significant societal changes, such as urbanisation and labour reform movements.

Pedagogy: Fish and Bone
Description: A method that breaks down complex topics into main ideas (the fish) and supporting details (the bones). This visual approach enhances comprehension by highlighting essential concepts and their relevant explanations.
Example: During a Biology class on human anatomy, the teacher uses the fish and bone technique to teach about the human skeletal system. Teacher presents the main components of the human skeleton (fish) and elaborates on each bone's structure and function (bones).

Pedagogy: Concept Mapping
Description: An effective way to visually represent relationships between ideas. Learners create diagrams connecting key concepts, aiding in understanding the overall structure of a subject and fostering retention.
Example: In a Psychology assignment, students use concept mapping to explore the various theories of personality. They interlink different theories, such as Freud's psychoanalysis, Jung's analytical psychology, and Bandura's social-cognitive theory, to see how they relate to each other.

Pedagogy: Audio Visual Resources
Description: Incorporating multimedia elements like videos, images, and audio into lessons. This approach caters to different learning styles, making educational content more engaging and memorable.
Example: In a General Science class, the teacher uses a documentary-style video to teach about the solar system. The video includes stunning visual animations of the planets, interviews with astronomers, and background music, enhancing students' interest and understanding of space.

Pedagogy: Think, Pair, and Share
Description: A collaborative learning technique where students ponder a question or problem individually, then discuss their thoughts in pairs or small groups before sharing with the entire class. It fosters active participation, communication skills, and diverse perspectives.
Example: In a Literature in English class, the teacher poses a thought-provoking question about a novel's moral dilemma. Students first reflect individually, then pair up to exchange their opinions, and finally participate in a lively class discussion to explore different viewpoints.

Pedagogy: Questioning Technique (Socratic Approach)
Description: Based on Socratic dialogue, this method stimulates critical thinking by posing thought-provoking questions. It encourages learners to explore ideas, justify their reasoning, and discover knowledge through a process of inquiry.
Example: In an Ethics class, the instructor uses the Socratic approach to lead a discussion on the meaning of justice. By asking a series of probing questions, the students engage in a deeper exploration of ethical principles and societal values.

Pedagogy: Practical Demonstration
Description: A hands-on approach where learners observe real-life applications of theories or skills. Practical demonstrations enhance comprehension, skill acquisition, and problem-solving abilities by bridging theoretical concepts with real-world scenarios.
Example: In a Food and Nutrition class, the instructor demonstrates the proper technique for filleting a fish. Students observe and then practice the skill themselves, learning the practical application of knife skills and culinary precision.

(**Note:** The examples provided in this annexure serve as illustrations of various pedagogies. It is important to understand that these pedagogies are versatile and can be applied across subjects in numerous ways. Feel free to adapt and explore these techniques creatively to enhance learning outcomes in your specific context.)

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